LISHA JAMES

BOARD CERTIFIED GENETIC COUNSELOR | VARIANT INTERPRETATION

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Board-certified genetic counselor (Level II) with 6 years across clinical genetics, NGS analysis, and ACMG/AMP variant classification, including hands-on experience as a genome analyst. Self-taught builder of the AI automation tools that a clinical genetic counseling team uses every day for session tracking, documentation and reporting, built with Google Apps Script, APIs and dashboards. Brings clinical judgment and practical technical skills to variant science, clinical bioinformatics and AI-in-healthcare roles.

CORE QUALIFICATIONS

Variant Classification & Databases: ACMG/AMP-based classification, ClinVar, OMIM, gnomAD-informed review, HGMD-style literature curation

NGS & Raw Data Analysis: NGS & Genomics: NGS data interpretation, reproductive genetics, NIPT, Sanger sequencing, cytogenetics (FISH, karyotyping, microarray)

Technical & Tools: Python Basics, Biopython, Bioinformatics, Artificial Intelligence, MS Office, Excel dashboards, structured case-tracking systems, AI tools for clinical documentation

Clinical Communication: Variant report review, plain-language patient counseling, structured clinical documentation, CME presentations, training, and mentoring

Quality & Compliance: CAP/NABL documentation standards, QA initiatives, zero major reporting discrepancies

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Genetic Counselor-II | Strand Life Sciences | Bengaluru *Aug 2021 - Present*

- Interpreted and counselled reports across 3,000+ genetic test reports using ACMG guidelines and current literature, spanning oncology, hereditary cancer, pediatric neurology, reproductive genetics, and consumer wellness products.
- Cross-referenced variant calls against ClinVar and OMIM to resolve classification inconsistencies and flag variants requiring further literature curation.
- Reviewed and approved wellness genetic test reports, auditing for data interpretation accuracy prior to release.
- Designed and implemented a structured case-tracking and automated documentation system, cutting case data retrieval time by 85% and reducing data redundancy by 80%.
- Built Excel-based dashboards to monitor Genetic Counseling case status, and summary completion metrics on a monthly and yearly basis.
- Conduct technical interviews for new genetic counselor hires, then train them and guide them as they shadow cases day to day; deliver CME presentations on genetic counseling and variant classification.

Consultant Genetic Counselor | Dr. Lal Path Labs | New Delhi *May 2021 - Aug 2021*

- Delivered structured pre- and post-test counseling for pediatric and adult genetic disorders, translating variant findings into clear patient-facing summaries.
- Created standardized genetic counseling summaries to improve clarity and clinical documentation consistency.
- Coordinated with physicians on risk assessment and patient management planning based on report findings.

Genome Analyst | Eurofins Clinical Genetics | Bengaluru *Nov 2019 - May 2020*

- Analysed 300+ NGS datasets across pediatric and adult genetic disorders, reproductive genetics, and NIPT cases.
- Performed ACMG-based variant classification and curated clinically relevant literature to support interpretation.
- Maintained high data integrity with zero major reporting discrepancies.

Genetic Counselor - Trainee | St. John's Medical College & Hospital | Bengaluru *Nov 2018 - May 2019*

- Assisted in interpreting karyotyping, chromosomal microarray, and NGS reports; supported wet-lab cytogenetic procedures (FISH, karyotyping).

- Conducted thesis research on cytogenetic and genetic abnormalities associated with recurrent pregnancy loss, including pedigree analysis and risk assessment.
- Provided pre-test counseling for antenatal screening, including NT scans, NIPT, and invasive prenatal testing.

PROJECT EXPERIENCE - DATA & ANALYTICS (live demos at lishaj0707.github.io)

- **GC Session Tracker** *(Google Apps Script, Calendar API, Google Sheets):* Automatically syncs counseling sessions from Google Calendar into a master tracker, sorts and numbers them, and feeds live team dashboards, replacing manual data entry.
- **GC Clinical Documentation Web App** *(Google Apps Script, HTML):* Structured session form that generates a formatted genetic counseling summary, follow-up email note and test recommendation, standardizing documentation across the team.
- **GC Activity Tracker Bot** *(Google Chat API, Gmail, triggers):* Logs clinical interpretation queries and report reviews, supports one-click assignment and status updates, and posts daily digests to the team space.
- **Variant Curation Toolkit** *(Python, ClinVar, gnomAD):* In progress: command-line tool that gathers ClinVar and gnomAD evidence for a variant and flags ACMG/AMP criteria for curator review.
- **Genetic Risk Calculator** (Designed the work flow) Online risk calculator to assess genetic risk and flag when genetic testing is indicated.

EDUCATION

M.Sc. in Biomedical Genetics (Specialised in Genetic Counseling) - Vellore Institute of Technology | CGPA: 8.6 *(2017-2019)*
B.Sc. in Biomedical Science - Nitte University | CGPA: 8.0 *(2014-2017)*

PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

- Board of Genetic Counseling India (BGCI) - Level II Board Certification
- Google AI Professional Certificate - Coursera
- Genomic Data Science Specialization - Johns Hopkins University, Coursera (in progress); completed: Python for Genomic Data Science, Introduction to Genomic Technologies
- Data Science for Biologists - Biograde my
- Hands-on Workshop on Machine Learning in Genomics - Genome Guide
- Interpreting Genomic Variation: Overcoming Challenges in Diverse Populations - Wellcome Connecting Science

LEADERSHIP & PROFESSIONAL ENGAGEMENT

- “Monoallelic PMS2 Variant in a Consanguineous Family: A Hidden Case of Constitutional Mismatch Repair Deficiency” - Abstract & e-poster, REDRESS Conference 2025.
- “Variable Expressivity of CPLANE1 Variations: Genotype-Phenotype Correlation in Joubert Syndrome vs. Orofaciodigital Syndrome Type VI” - Abstract & e-poster, 9th BGCI Annual International Conference.
- Moderator and Volunteer, BGCI Annual International Conference (2024).
- “Transforming Healthcare: Exploring the Relevance of Telegenetics in Genetic Counseling” - Abstract & e-poster, international conference on natural products, nanomaterials & nanopharmaceuticals.
- Delegate and presenter, St. John's Hospital Bangalore - “Genetic Counseling: What, Why & When.”

TECHNICAL & LABORATORY SKILLS

- **Laboratory:** DNA isolation · PCR · Sanger sequencing · karyotype analysis · general biotechniques
- **Clinical:** Variant interpretation · pediatric & prenatal genetic counseling · pre-/post-test counseling · case management · genetic test coordination
- **Core Competencies:** NGS Data analysis · patient-centered counseling · collaboration & teamwork · problem solving · mentoring · adaptability

LANGUAGES

English | Malayalam | Tamil & Hindi (limited working proficiency) |